

My school and local features Teacher notes

BUILD Humanities | Sum1 W1 | SoW slot 27 | 40 minutes in one session

Teach the exact weekly objective below using the nine-stage lesson. Select one route for each pupil, receive their response in an accessible form and agree a next step. These notes include the worked explanations, answers and evidence expectations.

Objective and evidence

Name and locate my school and local features.

F: map check plus one independent location question.

- Name my school in my chosen response mode.
- Use a key to locate two features.
- Show where one feature is in relation to the school.

Preparation and access

Before teaching, confirm the school name and two familiar nearby features. Use the school's approved local plan if available; otherwise make a shared plan from the classroom viewpoint. Do not ask for home addresses. The supplied fictional plan is for modelling; the independent response must transfer to the pupil's actual school.

Point, speak, sign, draw, write or direct an adult. An adult may read or scribe your exact words. Choose one route; do not complete all three.

A map is a view from above, not a picture of the front of a building. Keep the page orientation fixed before using left and right.

Vocabulary to teach first

locate (Tier 2): find and show where something is.

feature (Tier 2): something you can identify in a place.

key (Tier 3): the guide explaining map symbols.

symbol (Tier 3): a mark that stands for something.

route (Tier 3): the way from one place to another.

near (Tier 2): a short distance away in this plan.

A school caretaker uses a site plan to locate places and guide visitors. Practise giving a visitor one clear direction.

Teaching sequence

Stage	Minutes	Teacher action and pupil task
Title	0	Name one place you recognise near school.
Arrival	4	Choose one route and answer four retrieval questions.
Starter	4	Point to the school symbol using the key.
I Do	5	Watch how I locate the school and park.
We Do	5	Match each symbol to the feature it represents.
I Do 2	4	Watch how I describe a route from school to the library.
We Do 2	4	Choose the direction from school to the library.
Independent	10	Name your school and locate two nearby features on your own plan.
Exit	4	Show one feature in relation to the school.

I Do worked explanation 1

I read the key: a square marked S stands for school. I find S at the lower left. The triangle marked P is the park at the upper left. The park is above the school on this plan. I use the symbol and position together.

I Do worked explanation 2

I start at S, the school. I follow the dashed route to L, the library. I move right across the page. My direction is: "From school, go right to the library." The plan is a teaching example, so it does not tell us a safe walking route outside.

We Do checks

Which symbol means park?

The key shows P in a triangle for park. Read each map's own key.

From S to L, which direction crosses this page?

The library is to the right of the school on this fixed plan.

Arrival questions and answers

Use one route only. Hints sit beside questions in the lesson and pupil resources. Accept equivalent meaning in the pupil's response mode.

Supported

1. Which place is for learning: school or river?

Answer: School.

2. The key says S = school. What does S mean?

Answer: School.

3. Point to the right side of this page.

Answer: The right side of the page.

4. Choose a natural feature: river or library.

Answer: River.

Standard

1. Name a place people visit near a school.

Answer: Accept a suitable local place; check the actual locality with the adult.

2. Why does a map have a key?

Answer: To explain what the symbols mean.

3. A library is on the right of a school on a plan. Which way would you point?

Answer: Right across the page.

4. Which is human-made: a river or a bus stop?

Answer: Bus stop.

Stretch

1. How could you check the name of your school?

Answer: Read the school sign or confirm with a trusted adult.

2. Why can the same square mean different things on different maps?

Answer: Symbols depend on the key; do not assume their meaning.

3. What must stay fixed when we say left or right on a plan?

Answer: The orientation of the plan, or an agreed viewpoint.

4. Can a classroom plan prove a route is safe outside?

Answer: No. An adult must check the actual route and current conditions.

Independent task and exit

Supported

Name your school to the adult. Draw a school box. Add or point to two nearby features you know. Show one position with above, below, left or right. The adult may scribe your exact words.

Exit: On the teaching plan, point to the park in relation to the school.

Expected evidence: The park is above the school on the page. Accept pointing or a directed adult response.

Standard

Draw a simple plan of your school and two real nearby features. Add a key. Describe one feature's position using left, right, near or far. Tell the adult which detail needs checking.

Exit: Name your school and describe where one real feature is on your plan.

Expected evidence: School name and one plausible relative position, checked by the adult against the local setting.

Stretch

Draw and label a school plan with three local features and a key. Explain one position and how you would check it against the real place. Explain why this plan alone cannot confirm a safe walking route.

Exit: Explain how the key and a position word together help someone find a feature.

Expected evidence: The key identifies the feature; a position word tells the reader where to look.

Use the feedback response loop

Provide Space, invite Voice, genuinely receive the response as Audience, then agree Influence. A button records the agreed step; it does not itself prove learning. Keep each stage's response separate. In I Do stages the teacher models without a pupil-response panel. Use the next stage to check understanding.

Record the support used. If a pupil declines, consider regulation, communication, demand, relationship and timing; offer another route or revisit. Do not make completion of a digital panel a condition for access to the next task.

Accreditation caveat from the SoW

UAS means unit Award Scheme: match evidence to the exact selected unit and its requirements before submission. The plans do not identify approved unit codes.

Policy wording and source checks

The quotations below use the supplied Feedback and Marking Policy 2025/2026 Pilot, Issue 1. Body section numbers are used because the contents page differs.

Space

“Regulation first. A dysregulated student cannot respond to feedback. Co-regulation and time take priority over the technical content of the feedback.”

“A trusted key adult or familiar teacher.”

“Time to think. Student is given enough time to form a response”

“A clear, low-cognitive-load environment. Predictable lesson structure. Communication-friendly displays.”

“Permission to refuse; refusal is treated as information. Adults consider regulation, communication, task demand, relationship and timing, then re-offer feedback through an alternative modality where appropriate. Patterns of refusal inform APDR, regulation planning and curriculum access.”

“Establish Space at the start of the lesson - regulation, key adult, success criteria visible, no public comparison.”

First five quotations: body §5, PDF page 8. Final quotation: body §14, PDF page 14.

Staff codes

VF = Verbal feedback given here · WS = Worked with support · I = Independent · NS + ... = Next step one specific thing · E = Evidence on EFL · R = Responded loop closed (Audience has happened) · // = Self-edit point · ? = Read this back to me

EFL capture at Exit

“30-second clip, photo, or one-line context note. Central tags only. Listen / look before tagging (Audience).”

Feedback Policy body §14, PDF page 14. Use an individual response, not an undifferentiated group outcome.

Content sources

Ordnance Survey, Mapzone. Map skills context. Our S/P/L plan and symbols are original teaching graphics, not OS symbols.

<https://www.ordnancesurvey.co.uk/mapzone/map-skills>

Original local-plan artwork. Fictional diagram. No scale, real school location or safe route is asserted.

Author-created for PACK-1R